Inside 1,000 Startups

What the TrustMRR revenue data actually says about who is making money

$13.5M	**$133.8M**	**500,597**	**65**
aggregate MRR	revenue, last 12 months	active subscriptions	countries represented

Source: TrustMRR verified payment-provider data · 1,000 records × 29 fields · snapshot frozen 30 July 2026

THE DATASET

What we are actually looking at

Every startup connects a live payment provider, so revenue is verified rather than self-reported.

1 Money

MRR, 30-day / 3-month / 12-month / all-time revenue, growth rates, active subscriptions

2 Business model

Value proposition, problem solved, pricing model, target persona, B2B vs B2C, category

3 Distribution

Domain rating, X followers, 30-day visitors, revenue per visitor, country

4 Liquidity

On-sale flag, asking price, revenue multiple — a live market for these businesses

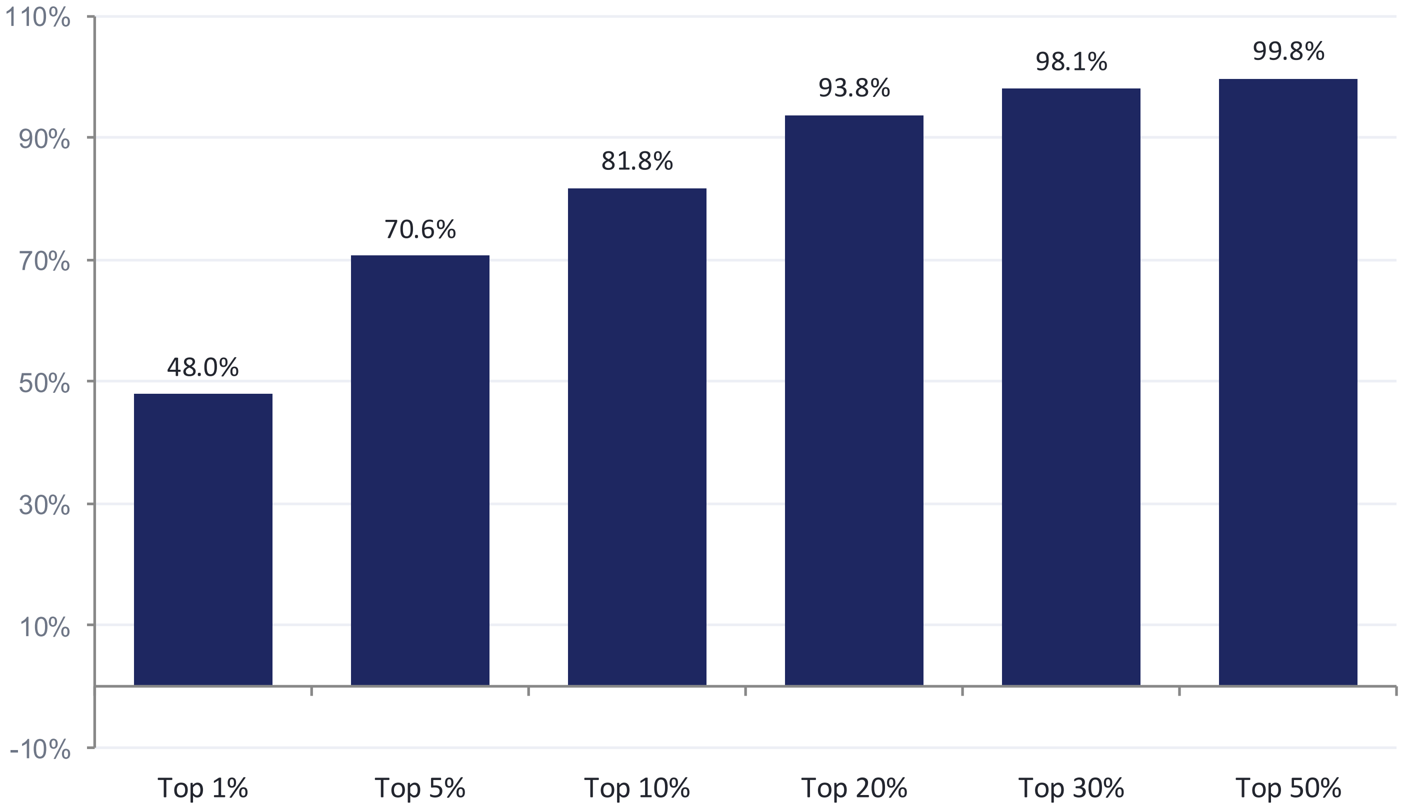
Coverage warning: the fields are not equally populated

100%	76%	73%	71%	18%
revenue & MRR	country	category	domain rating	web traffic

FINDING 01

Revenue is a brutal power law

The top 10 companies out of 1,000 earn more than the other 990 combined.



48%

of all MRR sits with the single largest company, Stan

$282

median monthly recurring revenue across the cohort

0.2%

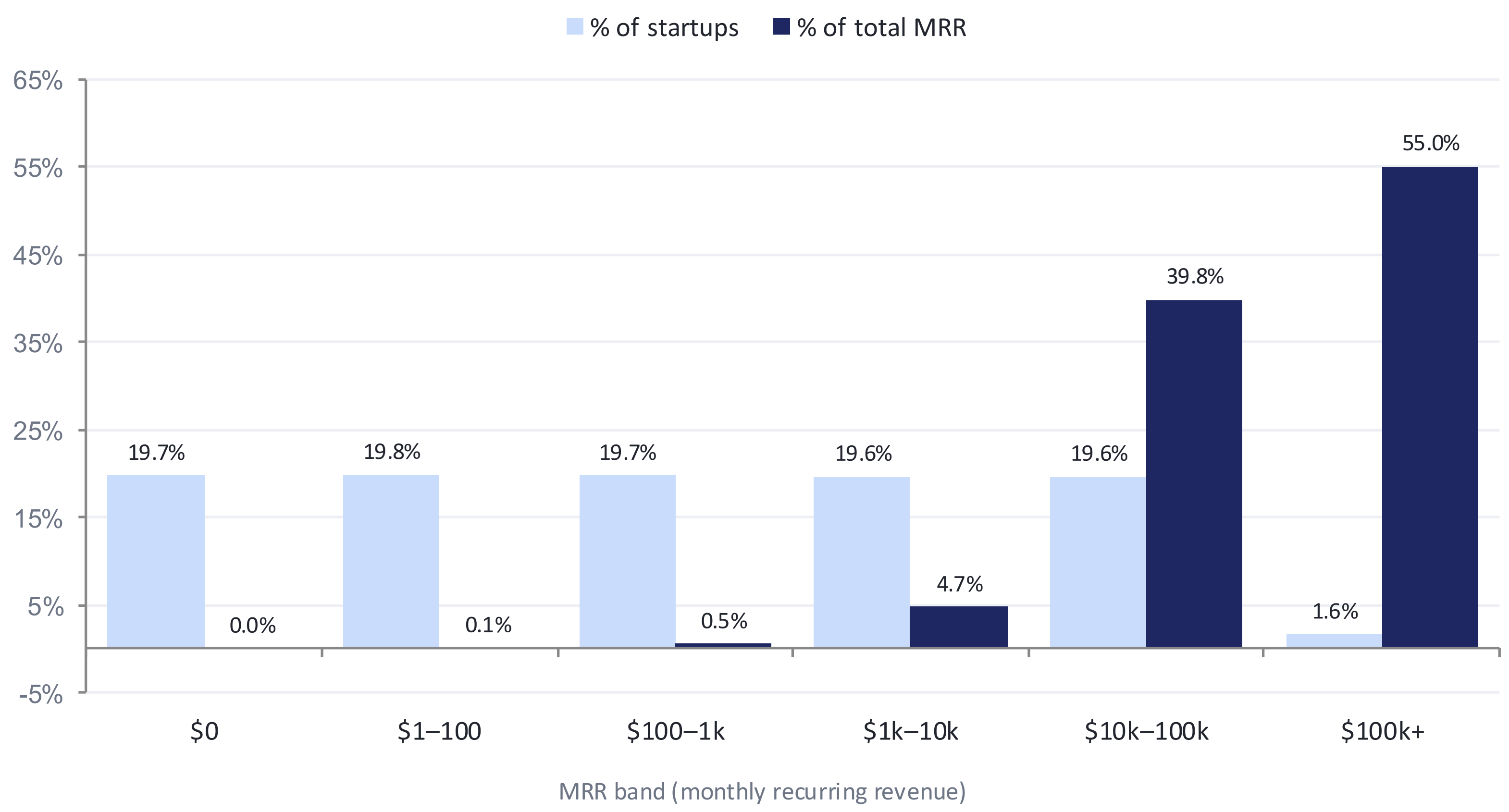
of MRR earned by the entire bottom half of the list

Averages are meaningless here. Mean MRR is $13,472 — 48× the median.

FINDING 02

Four out of five startups earn under $10k a month

The cohort splits cleanly into a long tail of experiments and a thin layer of real businesses.



Read this way

- 197 startups report zero MRR — a fifth of the list has connected billing but no recurring revenue.
- 16 companies above $100k/month carry 55% of the cohort's recurring revenue.
- The $10k–100k band is the real middle class: 196 companies, 40% of MRR.
- 162 startups show no revenue at all in the last 30 days.

FINDING 03

Most of the cohort is standing still

Median 30-day MRR growth is exactly 0%. Momentum concentrates where revenue already exists.

43%

flat — no change in MRR month over month

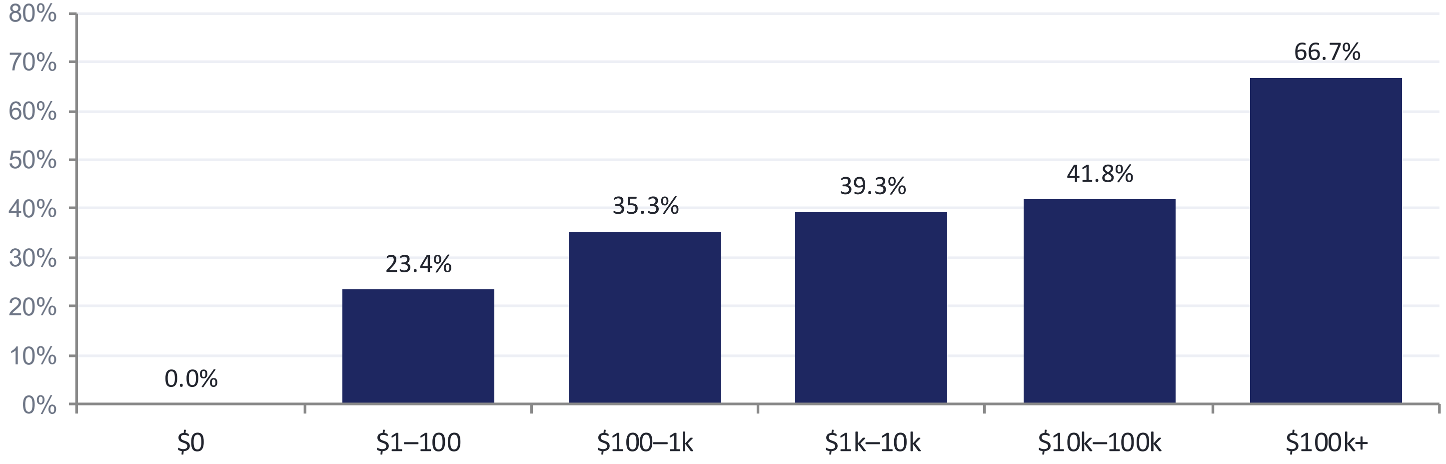
27%

shrinking — MRR down over 30 days

31%

growing — only 15% grew faster than 20%

Share of startups growing month over month, by revenue band



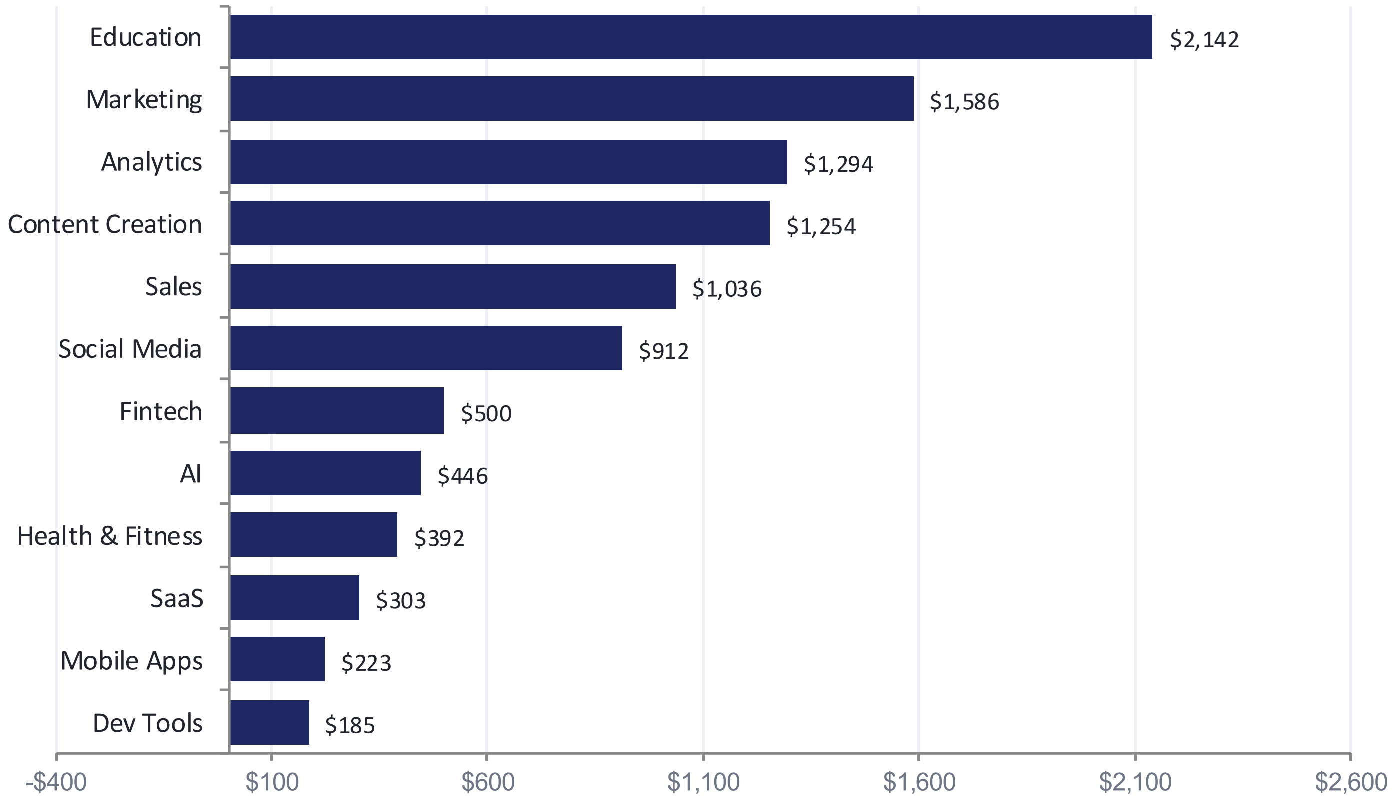
Growth compounds upward

- A startup above $10k MRR is roughly twice as likely to be growing as one under $100.
- Two-thirds of the $100k+ tier is still growing at scale.
- 55% of revenue-generating startups are running ahead of their trailing-year pace; 26% are behind it.

FINDING 04

AI is the most crowded category, not the richest

AI accounts for 27% of tagged startups. Education, Marketing and Analytics earn more per company.



197

AI startups — the largest single category, and the most competitive

$18.4M

12-month revenue from AI: the biggest pool, spread thinnest

Education

highest median MRR at $2,142 and the deepest subscriber bases

Dev Tools

lowest median MRR, but the fastest median growth at +8.9%

Categories with 10+ tagged startups · 726 of 1,000 records carry a category

FINDING 05

B2B is one third of the cohort and nearly two thirds of the money

Consumer startups win on volume of companies; business startups win on revenue per customer.

B2B

255 startups · 36% of tagged

- **$1,036** median MRR
- **$49** revenue per subscriber
- **58%** of all tagged MRR
- **16** median active subscriptions

B2C

401 startups · 56% of tagged

- **$181** median MRR
- **$9** revenue per subscriber
- **36%** of all tagged MRR
- **19** median active subscriptions

Both

56 startups · 8% of tagged

- **$352** median MRR
- **$23** revenue per subscriber
- **6%** of all tagged MRR
- **22** median active subscriptions

The pricing tell: 53% of startups that describe their pricing offer a free tier — and they run a median MRR of $159 against $751 for those that do not.

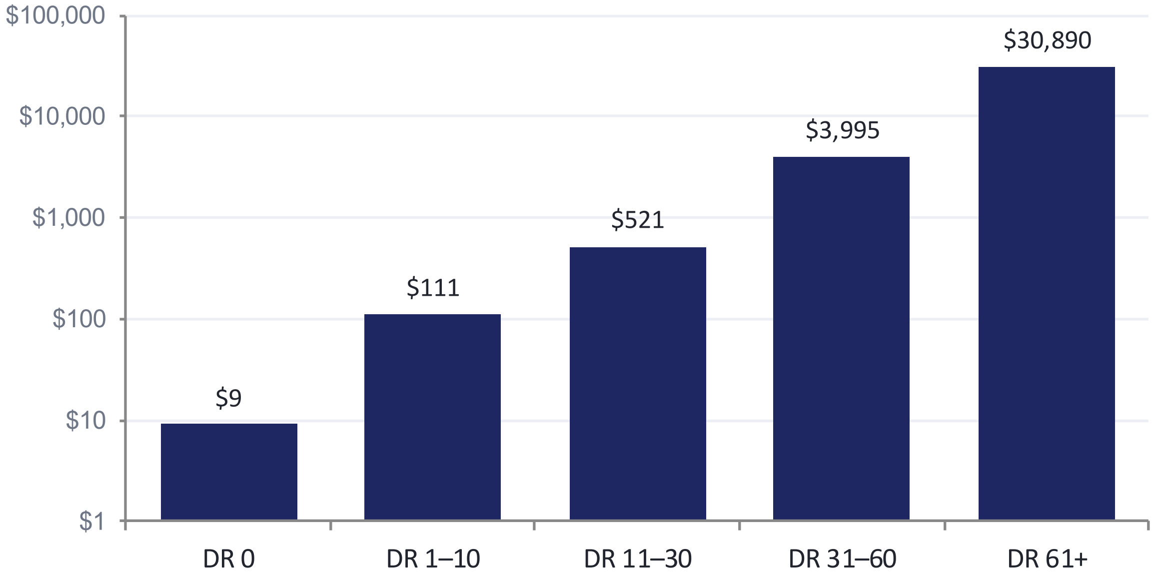
712 of 1,000 records carry an audience type · 657 describe a pricing model

■ FINDING 06

Owned distribution predicts revenue. Social following does not.

Domain authority tracks revenue closely; X follower counts barely move with it.

Median MRR by domain rating



Log scale · correlation with revenue 0.48, versus 0.18 for X followers

Where the money is collected

Stripe	**64.4%**	$11.8M MRR
RevenueCat	**19.1%**	$1.15M MRR
Dodo Payments	**5.0%**	$13k MRR
Polar	**4.0%**	$3k MRR
Lemon Squeezy / Paddle / other	**7.5%**	$0.5M MRR

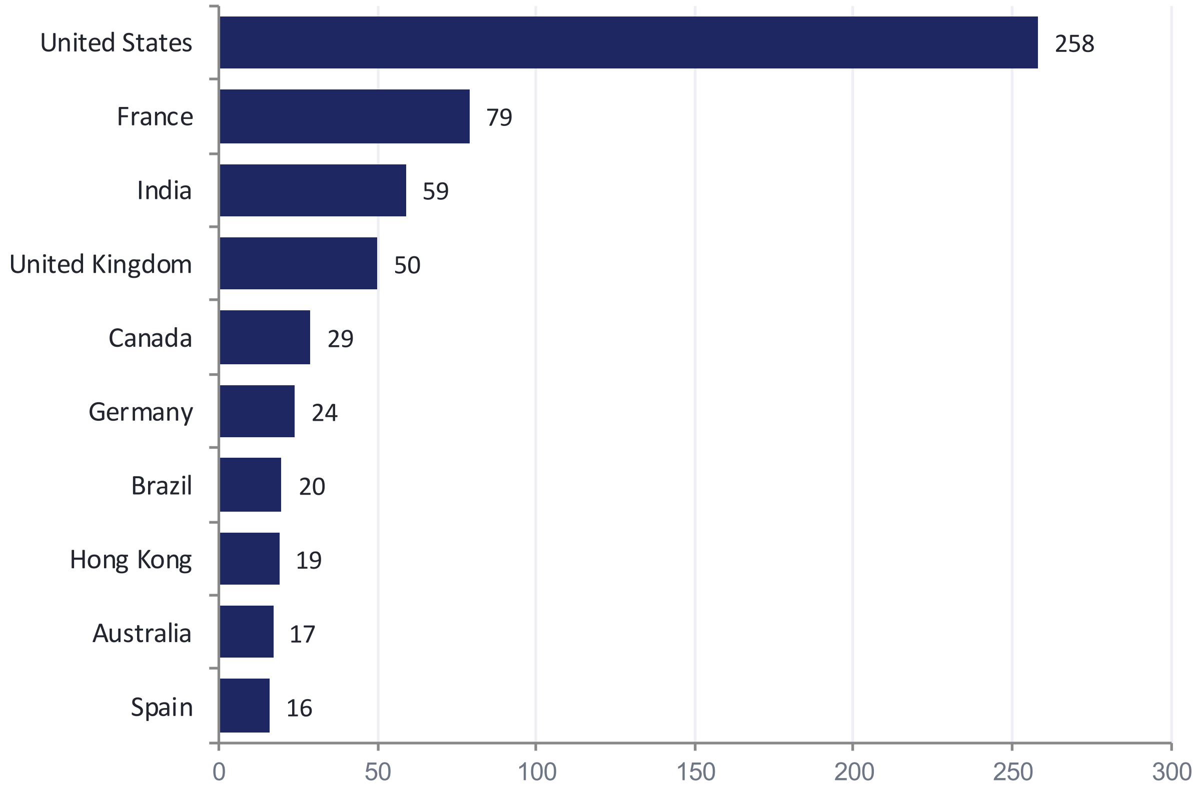
Consumer-mobile stacks skew differently: Superwall users show a median 1,534 subscriptions but low prices, while Stripe carries 88% of the cohort's MRR.

Domain rating available for 714 records · X followers for 984

FINDING 07

American startups dominate the revenue, not the headcount

The US is a third of the located startups and more than three quarters of located MRR.



$7.5M

US total MRR — 79% of all located revenue

$1,263

US median MRR, the highest of any major market

$6

India's median MRR across 59 startups — high volume, early stage

241

records with no country at all, a quarter of the dataset

759 of 1,000 records carry a country · 65 countries in total

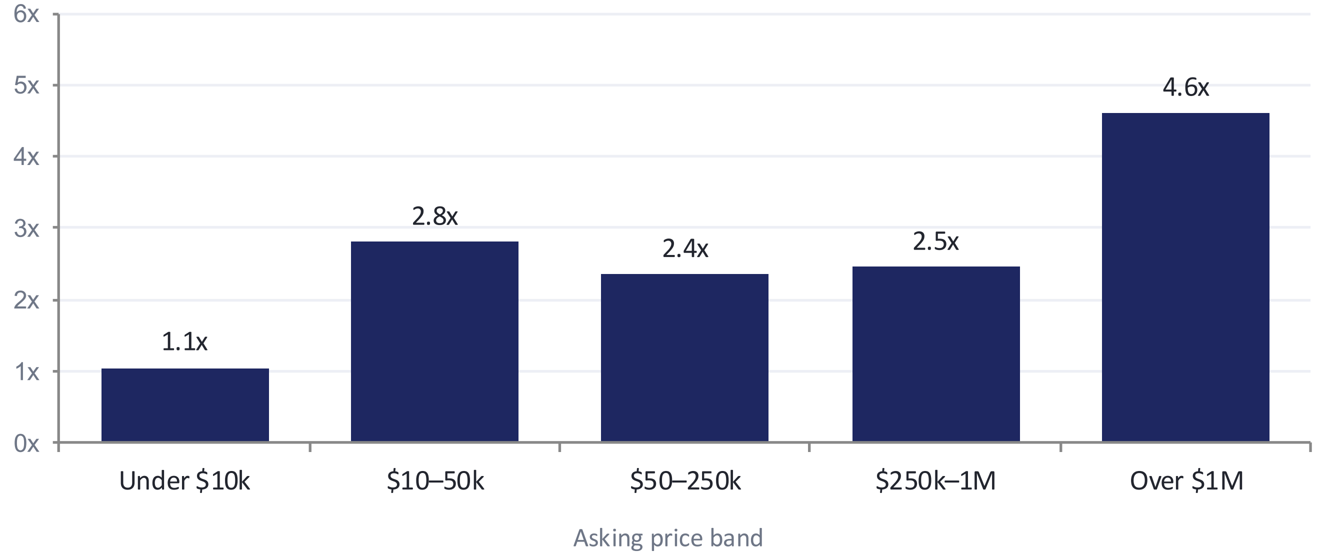
FINDING 08

A quarter of these startups are for sale

262 listings, $86.8M in combined asking price, at a median of 2.3× annual revenue.

262	**$86.8M**	**$35,000**	**2.3×**
startups listed for sale (26%)	combined asking price	median asking price	median revenue multiple

Bigger businesses command bigger multiples



What sellers look like

- Listed startups are materially larger: $1,055 median MRR versus $187 for those not on sale.
- 96 listings sit under $10,000 and price at just 1.05× revenue — near-abandoned assets.
- 21 listings ask over $1M and command 4.6×, the premium for scale and durability.
- AI and Mobile Apps are the most-listed categories — 83 of the 262 listings.

261 of 262 listings disclose an asking price

READ WITH CARE

Four things this data cannot tell you

The revenue figures are verified. Almost everything around them is partial.

Survivorship

Only startups that voluntarily connect a payment provider appear here. Failures and the privately profitable are both invisible.

Sparse traffic data

Visitors are recorded for 178 startups and revenue-per-visitor for 142. Any acquisition-efficiency conclusion rests on 14% of the sample.

Anonymous entries

129 records are labelled Stealth Company, several with six-figure MRR. They carry no category, persona or country.

A single 30-day window

Growth rates come from one month, ranging from −100% to +12,983%. Treat them as noisy signals, not trends.

SO WHAT

Five conclusions

01	**Scale, not survival, is the hard part**	Reaching $1k MRR is common — 40% of the cohort clears it. Reaching $10k is rare, and $100k is a rounding error at 1.6%.
02	**Momentum is bought with revenue**	The likelihood of growing rises at every band, from 23% under $100 MRR to 67% above $100k. Distress does not reverse itself.
03	**Crowded is not the same as lucrative**	AI has the most companies and the thinnest median. Education, Marketing and Analytics quietly out-earn it per company.
04	**Charge businesses, or charge more**	B2B is a third of the companies and 58% of the money, at 5× the revenue per subscriber.
05	**Owned distribution is the real moat**	Domain authority tracks revenue across every band. Social following barely does. SEO beats reach.

Analysis of 1,000 TrustMRR records · snapshot frozen 30 July 2026